

PHOTOSYNTHESIS

Pilot: "Greenlight"

by

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EXT. DIRTY CITY - DAWN

The gateway sign of DIRTY CITY, WOODWORK looms over the horizon. It reads: "The Cleanest City in the Garden Nation."

Beyond the sign, TERRACOTTA SKYSCRAPERS and CERAMIC POTHOUSES crowd the streets. These are where residents root themselves.

PARSLEY (V.O.)

It's dirt cheap in Dirty City in
the country of Woodwork. Here, life
is simple for the plants and bugs
growing up on this soil.

A PLANT CITIZEN walks a PET BEETLE. The beetle lifts a leg and pees on the "Cleanest" sign. A BEETLE BUG CAR drives past.

INT. BEETLE CAR - MOMENTS LATER

The car stops at a redlight. To the right is Salontro salon.

PARSLEY (V.O.)

You get sun, you get water...

EXT. SALONTRO - CONTINUOUS

PARSLEY RAM (11), a sprout in brown overalls with bushy green hair and human-like limbs, twirls a broom.

PARSLEY

...so long as your mom doesn't rip
your leaves off-

RAU RAM (36), a cilantro with gleaming hair and a Salontro apron, steps out. Her voice is firm but her eyes are weary.

RAU

Parsley! You can talk to your
imaginary friends once you finish
sweeping Salontro. Pronto?

Parsley droops his shoulder. Rau steps closer, placing her red hand (the mark of a transplant) on his green shoulder.

RAU (CONT'D)

Look at me. Out of both of us, *your*
roots came from this soil. You were
naturally born with green leaves I
am trying to earn. Don't sweep that
honor under the rug, my son.

Rau goes back inside. Parsley sighs, leaning on his broom.

PARSLEY

Love you, *mã* (Viet: "Mom")! Huh.
Imaginary friends don't judge roots
or care if your leaves red or green-

CUT TO:

INT. PARSLEY'S IMAGINATION - DAY

Parsley sits at a toadstool table. The MOSS-COVERED GNOME and LION'S MANE sit opposite of him, like board of directors.

PARSLEY

Mã (Viet: "Mom") says I'm the one
with the green hands. That I'm so
lucky. But if I don't grow tall
enough to be seen... what is the
point of being born here?

LION'S MANE

Worrying makes you bitter. Just be
a trendy garnish. Sit on a plate
and hope nobody's got an appetite.

EXT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - CONTINUOUS

A window in the next-door nightclub opens, revealing PYRUS CRABAPPLE (13), a pear in a tan hoodie. They see Parsley talk to himself. Pyrus looks at their SAXHORN, then back at him.

PARSLEY

Heck no to being a garnish! Full
course is where it's at!

INT. PARSLEY'S IMAGINATION - CONTINUOUS

MOSS GNOME

In this garden, you either bloom or
end up a garnish for a creature's
salad. Don't bloom. Blend in. Dirt
is safe. Become one with the mulch-

EXT. SALONTRO / FIGLEAF - CONTINUOUS

The Gnome's face is replaced by Pyrus, blasting a saxhorn.
Pyrus hides the instrument and climbs out of the window.

PYRUS

Holy moly. Your mom didn't say you
can't talk to your real friend?!

PARSLEY

Pyrus! You turnt my leaves white!

PYRUS

(to thin air)

Ope ope! Save your narrating for
the sneezeworts. Germinations,
nobody! I'm Pyrus Crabapple!
Nibling of Malus, owner of FigLeaf
Nightclub. Salontro neighbor. But
mostly, this city knows Parsley and
I make a great pair...

PARSLEY

...of trouble. You dirty pear. Been
counting how many sweeps I got in?

PYRUS

Nah. Just watching that beetle. It
ain't moving from that redlight.

Parsley turns to see the beetle car under the stoplight.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

Let's make 'em yellow. Oh Bombus!

Rather than the side door of FigLeaf, a CAT-SIZED PET BEE
named BOMBUS, smashes out of the side window.

BOMBUS

Buzzzzzzzzzzzzzz!

PARSLEY

You still gotta door-train the bee.

Bombus flies and lands on the stoplight. They squeeze their
body in the redlight and emit a yellow glow.

The beetle car moves and stops in front of Salontro. VERBENA
(20s) steps out, clutching a clipboard. She is a sleek,
purple-petaled plant with the poise of a reality TV producer.
She wears a sharp, leaf-fiber blazer and oversized shades.

Rau swiftly steps outside. She whispers to Parsley and Pyrus.

RAU

Parsley, hide our Bee's Knees
ointments. It's not WDA-approved.
(to Pyrus)
Don't get us in trouble. AGAIN.

Parsley rushes inside Salontro. Pyrus follows and makes a
loud crash inside. Rau shuts her eyes, trying to ignore it.

RAU (CONT'D)

Welcome to Salontro. The finest
salon in all of Woodwork-

VERBENA

Relax. I'm no inspector.

RAU

Oh thank the higher farmer.

VERBENA

Verbena. Location scouting for Lami-

RAU

Lami... Lami Mentha of-

ON SCREEN: A bold "GET" logo, a green parody of the BET logo,
with a leaf substituted for the star pops briefly behind
Verbena with a drop of a hip-hop beat.

VERBENA

Mint Condition, only on G E T.

Rau whips out a bunch of DVD and VHS cases.

RAU

I have every season on Green-Ray,
DVD, and VHS!

SMASH CUT TO:

TV SCREEN - MINT CONDITION - 3 DECADES AGO

Grainy, over-saturated footage. A mint plant, LAMI MENTHA
(20s) and an unnamed TULIP are having a soap-opera moment.

TULIP

(Sobbing pollen)

You said we'd be perennial! But
you're just a single year! Are we
not *mint* to be?!

LAMI

Read my lips, you dumb Tulip!

The Tulip gasps as a single petal falls in slow motion. Neon
letters SLAM onto the screen: TO BE CONTINUED...

RAU (V.O.)

Missed the soap opera days before
Mint Condition became reality shows-

BACK TO:

EXT. SALONTRO - PRESENT

Verbena stares at Rau, visibly weirded out by her fandom.

VERBENA

...VHS? Anywho, I wasn't planning to make a stop here, but your bee helped get me out of the red.

RAU

Bombus is the bee's knees! Dirty City really needs to fix that red-

VERBENA

Stop! Not another word. I want to get my fix of your soil. Is it the diamond in the rough, seed in the dirt? Let's see if your Salontro salon is truly in *Mint Condition*.

INT. SALONTRO - CONTINUOUS

The salon is a blend of a Vietnamese spa and greenhouse. Vines frame the mirrors while mossy tanning beds lie about.

As Verbena's heels click while entering, Parsley frantically shoves honey-ish Bee's Knees jars underneath the floorboards.

Pyrus is somehow tangled above in a hanging vine.

Rau looks up in surprise. She shushes with her index finger.

RAU

Shh... How...?

VERBENA

(Unimpressed)

How... earthy. A bit transplant-chic, isn't it? Lami prefers something with prestige and safety.

RAU

Transplant...

Rau's smile has enough pressure to crush a rock.

RAU (CONT'D)

Madam Verbena, Salontro is the green standard. We have never once had a soiled incident. We are the safest ecosystem in Dirty City!

CUT TO:

FLASHBACK - A WEEK AGO

A DANDELION sits in the styling chair. Rau accidentally hits the turbo-mist button.

RAU

Ope.

The Dandelion suddenly EXPLODES into countless white seeds.

DANDELION

Keep... the... change!

The seeds fly everywhere, clogging the vents and triggering the fire alarm. Most drift out the door.

BACK TO:

INT. SALONTRO - PRESENT

Rau is still smiling, as a single white dandelion seed drifts down and lands on her nose. She subtly sneezes it away.

RAU

...safe as a-

Pyrus drops and lands face down next to Verbena. They get up.

PYRUS

What she means is, this place has soul. According to... uh... local legends...

Pyrus pulls the FURROW BARK JOURNAL from their hoodie, hiding it from Rau and Verbena but showing Parsley.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

This book says this salon is built on a spiritual sap-line. If we crank the misting system all the way up, Lami will glow so bright she'll be visible from Woody Holly!

PARSLEY

Pyrus! That's my mom's journal! She keeps it under her bed! How'd-

PYRUS

Ope! I might've "borrowed" it while she was waiting at the redlight. It looked like a cookbook, but it's full of weird science.

PARSLEY

The only thing more dangerous than
a bad idea is...

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

...a weirdo.

PYRUS

Boredom.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

Wait until you see the lighting,
Verbena! It's... condition-breaking-

RAU

Don't you dare.

VERBENA

Bold words for a garnish. Show me.

Pyrus grabs a lever on the wall labeled: "DO NOT TOUCH. THAT
MEANS YOU, PYRUS."

PYRUS

What does it say - Oh can't read-

THE MUSIC KICKS IN: Rocky Vietnamese. Pyrus slams the lever.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

The "Cleanest City in Woodwork" is
about to get real messy.

WHOOSH! A blast of emerald light and herbal mist explodes
from the vents. Verbena's purple hair turns neon green.

Parsley and Pyrus look at each other, horrified and thrilled.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

Quick, let's capture this moment on
the Salontro cam!

Pyrus grabs the leaf-shaped camera.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...
Photo!

FLASH. The image captures Verbena looking shocked, Rau ready
to faint, and the two kids giving thumbs up.

INT. SALONTRO - MOMENTS LATER

The emerald haze thins, revealing Verbena standing like a
statue. Her hair pulses neon green. She seems mesmerized.

Rau frantically fans the air with a carpet.

RAU

I'm so sorry! The wiring here is...
Well, it's literally vines! I can
fix this, Verbena, I have a de-
oxidizing rinse in the back-

VERBENA

Don't you dare touch it.

Rau freezes, mid-fan.

RAU

(in Vietnamese; subtitled)
...*Xin loi?*
(Sorry?)

VERBENA

The luminosity... saturation...
it's like looking at a forest fire.
It's exactly the look Lami Mentha
needs to reboot her image.

Rau snaps out of her shock. Her eyes dart from Verbena to the
"DO NOT TOUCH" lever, then back to the kids. She sees the
opportunity of a lifetime. She smooths her apron and strikes
a pose, pretending the chaos was choreography.

RAU

Exactly! You've just experienced...
The Greenlight! Salontro's
exclusive, *patent-pending*, deep-
tissue Heliophyte Highlights!

Verbena is transfixed by her glowing leafy hands.

VERBENA

Greenlight Highlights. As producer,
green and light sound expensive.

RAU

Oh, it's premium! It um... uses
Paddy-sap to revitalize the
chlorophylls! It's the diamond in
the rough you've been looking for.

Rau shoots a look at Pyrus that says "I'll compost you later."

RAU (CONT'D)

But it's such a delicate process.
So high maintenance. It requires
total environmental control.

Verbena swiftly writes on her clipboard.

VERBENA

Fab. Lami loves high maintenance. I want the full Greenlight highlights for her. The mist, *neon diamond*. Don't change a single molecule.

Lami arrives tomorrow. If you can recreate this Greenlight highlights for the cameras, Salontro will be the lead feature of the new season.

RAU

Tomorrow? The mulch isn't ready!

VERBENA

Keep the mulch dirty, transplant. It's *authentic*. Be in touch!

Verbena exits with her heels clicking. Rau sinks in a chair.

Parsley grabs the grinning Pyrus by the hoodie.

PYRUS

See? I told you, we're gonna be on Green-Ray... and *VH-DVD* what?!

PARSLEY

Pyrus, we aren't geniuses. Look!

Parsley points to the journal still open on the floor. He points to a warning written in red ink at the bottom.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

Warning: Photosynthesis of high-maintenance plants, such as mints, may cause total cellular implosion.

PYRUS

Ope. The paparazzis...?

PARSLEY

If Lami Mentha wilts on national TV because we over-cooked her...

SMASH CUT TO:

EXT. WOODY HOLLY RED CARPET - IMAGINATION

The paparazzi (literal FIREFLIES with flashing cameras) swarm LAMI MENTHA (50s). She strikes a pose, but her emerald glow suddenly turns a sickly brown. With a sound like a deflating balloon, she collapses into a pile of dried mint leaves.

LAMI

Call... my... publicist...

A fancy BONSAI accidentally steps on her, turning her to dust.

BACK TO:

INT. SALONTRO - PRESENT

PARSLEY

...we'll all turn into potpourri.

ON SCREEN: A PHOTO OF POTPOURRI. A photo of colorful, dried potpourri mix (pinecones, herbs, and dried flowers) pops up right next to Parsley's face, with a popping sound effect.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

Not only did we book mom a TV deal
but a seat to the end of the world.

Pyrus grabs their leaf-shaped phone.

PYRUS

The classic Parsley-Pyrus special:
one part dream, two parts doom. If
we're going down, might as well
document the evidence!

PARSLEY & PYRUS

(Shaky)

Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...
Photo...

FLASH. The image captures Parsley in pure dread while Pyrus gives a thumbs up that looks more like a cry for help.

EXT. FIGLEAF - NIGHT

The nightclub bops ultraviolet lights next to the dark salon.

Several big FIREFLIES flicker. Bombus chases them about.

A red apple and nightclub owner named MALUS CRABAPPLE (50s)
sits on a crate out front, nursing a bottle of sap.

Pyrus approaches their unty Malus. Parsley is alongside them.

MALUS

Heard the news, sprouts. Lami? What
a diva. She's got enough ego to
shade an entire forest. Why's a
mint like her coming to Dirty City?

PYRUS

A location scout chose Salontro,
Unty Malus.

PARSLEY

She said we've got soul!

MALUS

Scouts don't choose soul. They
calculate. Lami ain't just a
singer. She is an enlister. She
finds the brightest plants, and
suddenly they ain't the
neighborhood no more. They ain't
touching my FigLeaf that's fosure.

Bombus lands on Parsley's head, buzzing a mournful tune that
sounds suspiciously like a funeral march.

Malus heads inside FigLeaf.

PARSLEY

The Greenlight feels a lot more
like a stoplight...

PYRUS

Don't listen to Unty Malus. They're
just sour grapes. Or sour apples.
Tomorrow, everything will be sweet!

Bombus becomes uplifting.

INT. SALONTRO - MOMENTS LATER

Rau is pacing, clutching a bottle of "Evergreen Shine."

RAU

Tomorrow. Tomorrow! I have to
prepare the Paddy Kingdom infusion.
If I can just get Lami to endorse
my "Cilantro Calm" serum, we can
afford to move to Woody Holly!

PARSLEY

Má (Viet: "Mom"), maybe we should
just stick to the regular lights?
Ones that don't smell like ozone?

RAU

Son, look at this place. We've
worked so hard.

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)

This is our chance to finally bloom
where we're planted. Don't worry.
Your mother knows what she's doing.

Rau heads off to bed.

Parsley gets out the Journal and flips through until they
find the page.

PARSLEY

HOW TO STOP TOTAL CELLULAR
IMPLOSION. Step one: Find a Moon
Fungus. Step two: Don't get caught.

Pyrus and Bombus pop their heads through the back window.

PYRUS

Psst. Lil herb. Want to go on a
midnight garden raid?

PARSLEY

(Sighing)

Step two is optional...

Parsley joins Pyrus by the window.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

(Quietly)

Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...

PARSLEY

Photo.

FLASH. The image captures Parsley climbing out the back
window with Pyrus.

EXT. WOODWORK NATIONAL PARK - NIGHT

A dense fog clings to the forest grounds. Giant mushrooms
tower overhead like umbrellas. Parsley and Pyrus are trekking
through the underbrush, with Bombus holding a flashlight.

PARSLEY

I thought Bombus was a bumblebee...

PYRUS

Bombus is whatever they wanna be.

PARSLEY

The Journal says the Moon Fungus is
found only in the shady acres.

(MORE)

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

It's the one thing strong enough to keep a plant from wilting under heavy photosynthesis. It also glows green when it's ripe. See any light-Ah!

Holding a flashlight underneath, Pyrus makes a scary face, startling Parsley.

PYRUS

I am the light.

PARSLEY

Knock it off. You're scary enough under sunlight.

PYRUS

Say that again and I'll have Bombus fire you into the sun.

Bombus flies off to a circle of glowing mushrooms.

BOMBUS

(Staccato)

Buzz!

PYRUS

There goes Bombus, at it again.

An elegant Moon Fungus blooms in the center of a circle of glowing mushrooms. It pulses like a heartbeat. The gills shimmer with a haunting, cosmic green.

PARSLEY

(Gasping)

The Moon Fungus.

PYRUS

Easy peasy, lemon-squeezy.

A few PINE CONES drop near Parsley and Pyrus.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

Pine cones?

THUJA (O.S.)

I wouldn't squeeze that if I were you, scouts!

PARK RANGER THUJA CARPENTER (40s) DROP from above, landing with a ground-shaking THUD. They are a massive pine tree with an ornament eye patch. They hold a rake like a trident.

The Moon Fungus's pulse skips a beat and changes color from green to yellow.

PARSLEY

Did it just turn yellow.

PYRUS

You owe me a fertilizer popsicle if it turns red.

The Moon Fungus changes from yellow to red.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

You owe me.

PARSLEY

I didn't agree to anything...

THUJA

You didn't agree to the closed sign either. The fungi here got feelings. You stress it out, it stops being medicine and starts being a landmine.

PARSLEY

They need therapy like you, Pyrus.

THUJA

You city kids are like aphids. You show up, suck the life out of the park, and leave a sticky mess.

PYRUS

Wow. What a grumpy Christmas tree.

THUJA

(Eye patch twitching)

I'm not *ornament* to be a Christmas tree! You want to spend the night in a compost bin?

PARSLEY

Ranger! We're... We're just on a... midnight biology field trip?

THUJA

(Squinting)

Midnight biology? At two in the morning? In a restricted growth zone? You kids from Dirty City think the rules are just "suggestions," don't you?

PYRUS

Look, Ranger, we're on a mission of mercy! If we don't get that fungus, a major celebrity is going to turn into a raisin on national TV!

THUJA

(Chuckling)

Lami Mentha? I heard she was coming. That plant wouldn't know real nature if it bit her on the stamen. But the Moon Fungus is endangered. You can't just pick it.

MUSIC CUES: FAST-PACED BLUEGRASS/FOLK FUSION

Bombus buzzes to the bass of the music.

BOMBUS

Buzz. Buzz. Buzz. Buzz.

PYRUS

The bass is a cue for... Run, lil herb!

The Moon Fungus changes from red to green.

THE CHASE BEGINS

Thuja swings their rake. Parsley and Pyrus DUCK and weave. Thuja smashes the ground and it EXPLODES into mulch.

Parsley runs in zig-zags.

PARSLEY

Journal! What does it say about angry pines?!

Pyrus does a parkour flip over a mushroom.

PYRUS

The Journal doesn't cover "Aggressive Horticulture"! But a bumblebee sting always works!

Thuja vaults over a giant mushroom.

THUJA

I told that Gardener not to leave this book lying around! You kids are a menace to the ecosystem!

Bombus performs a dizzying loop around Thuja's head.

THUJA (CONT'D)

Get off me, you oversized gnat! I
can't think straight!

Bombus squirts a stream of honey-ink onto Thuja's eye.

THUJA (CONT'D)

My vision! Delicious... but blurry!

Bombus lands a "sting" (they write a glowing insult in honey-ink on the ground: "YER MOM'S A SPRUCE-GOOSE!")

Thuja stops, trying to read the insult.

THUJA (CONT'D)

Yer mom's a spruce-goose?! That's
uncalled for! My mother was a
lovely hemlock!

Parsley steps forward in earnest.

PARSLEY

Ranger, please! We're not vandals!
We're just... we're just kids
trying to keep a salon from
exploding!

THUJA

A classic tale of kids coming
together to save... a salon?

PYRUS

From exploding!

Thuja looks at the journal in Parsley's hand, then at the glowing green dust on Bombus. They sigh, lowering their rake.

THUJA

That book. Only one plant ever had
the guts to write down the secrets
of the soil. Aren't you the
cilantro's kid?

PARSLEY

Yes. And I'm not gonna let my mom's
dream wilt because I was too scared
to face a pine tree.

THUJA

Fine. If I catch you back here
again, you both will be sawdust.

Pyrus nudges Parsley.

PYRUS

See? Everyone loves a garnish.

Bombus flies to the Moon Fungus and gently rolls in the petals, coming away covered in glowing green dust.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

(Holding up the phone)

Ranger! Smile for the fans!

PARSLEY & PYRUS

Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...

THUJA

Photo!

FLASH. The image captures Thuja poking their rake at Pyrus's hair and Parsley celebrating with a glowing green Bombus.

EXT. SALONTRO - MORNING

Everything is a circus. Several chrome-plated beetle-limos are parked haphazardly across the sidewalk.

PARSLEY (V.O.)

(Tired yet wired)

The Moon Fungus pollen has been safely stashed in my overalls, but it's making my leaves itchy.

PYRUS (V.O.)

Woody Holly has officially moved into our neighborhood!

PARSLEY (V.O.)

And they brought a ton of luggage.

A crew of PLANTS in headsets is hauling heavy film equipment into the salon.

Verbena is barking orders into a megaphone made of a hollowed-out gourd.

VERBENA

Everyone stay in your root-marks! Remember, we're filming for GET, not some public access community garden! I want GRITTY, I want RAW, but I want it to look like it cost a million bags of premium mulch!

Parsley and Pyrus, disheveled and covered in fungi, slip past security. Verbena blocks their path with her clipboard.

VERBENA (CONT'D)

You're late! The talent is already here, and she's complaining that the vibes too oxygenated. Where have you been?

PYRUS

Ope- Nature hike!

RAU (PRE-LAP)

Nature hike?!

INT. SALONTRO - CONTINUOUS

The salon is unrecognizable. Neon "Mint Condition" signs hang from the vine mirrors.

In a whirlwind of motion, Rau's hands vibrate like a dozen frantic leaves as she preps the Paddy infusion. She wipes dirt from Parsley's face before shoving the kids away.

RAU

You two look like compost.

Pyrus adjusts their hoodie.

PYRUS

Compost is haute couture, ma'am.
The next network we'll book is
Green Fashion Week!

In the center chair sits a mint plant with diamond-encrusted leaves, LAMI MENTHA (50s). She hasn't slept in forever.

LAMI

Rau, darling. If I don't look like a green goddess soon, I'm going to have my producers "edit" this salon out of existence.

RAU

(Sweating sap)
Almost ready, Madam Mentha!
Parsley! Get the misting-wand!

Parsley rushes to the back, pulling Pyrus into the supply closet.

PARSLEY

Okay, the Journal says we have to mix the green pollen with the Paddy infusion. It creates a chemical barrier against the Supernova.

Pyrus dumps the green-glowing Bombus into a spray bottle.

PYRUS

Shake it, don't stir it. We want
her stabilized, not carbonated.

PARSLEY

Breath in. Breath out. This is it.
The Greenlight moment.

INT. SALONTRO - MOMENTS LATER

VERBENA

(to the cameras)
And... action!

Lami turns to the lens with a celebrity smile. She walks
through the salon like she's giving a guided tour of a palace.

LAMI

Welcome back to *Mint Condition*.
Today, we're keeping it "soiled" in
Dirty City. I'm at Salontro, a
"Paddish salon" where the roots are
deep and the mist is... intense.

Lami gestures with a diamond-encrusted leaf towards Rau.

LAMI (CONT'D)

This is Rau Ram, the owner of
Salontro. She's a cilantro
transplant from Paddy Kingdom with
a dream. Say hi to the camera.

RAU

Germinations.

LAMI

In like- your language.

RAU

Chào...

LAMI

She can style any hedge at a
moment's notice.

Rau waves her hands nervously.

LAMI (CONT'D)

Salontro is the talk of Woodwork.
A haven for plants who want that
"authentic adaptation" look.

(MORE)

LAMI (CONT'D)

And today, Rau is giving me highlights so exclusive, it isn't even in the plot yet. It's called GREENLIGHT!

THE MUSIC KICKS IN: Vietnamese traditional zither music.

RAU

Hold. Hold.

LAMI

Cut, you mean.

RAU

Do we have to play this?

LAMI

Isn't this the music of your land?

RAU

We're in Woodwork, Lami. This land has DJ Cauliflower.

LAMI

Alright. Whatever doesn't get your cruciferous in a bunch.

THE MUSIC SHIFTS: The traditional zither is scratched away by a hip-hop beat drop.

VERBENA

Rolling!

Lami sits on a salon chair.

Rau begins the misting ritual.

Parsley steps forward, holding the special sprayer. He mists Lami with a fine, green-tinted cloud.

LAMI

(Inhaling)

Ooh... that's... refreshing. My stems feel like... moonlight.

Pyrus leans over the "DO NOT TOUCH" lever.

PYRUS

Ready for the glow-up of the century, lil herb?

PARSLEY

(Nodding to the camera)

Ready.

Pyrus slams the lever to "SUPERNOVA."

WHOOSH! The emerald light explodes. But this time, instead of smoke and green hair, Lami begins to glow with a perfect, ethereal, diamond-emerald brilliance. She looks incredible.

VERBENA

Yes! Yes! The saturation! Her hair's synthesizing! This is the peak, Rau! This is the look G E T will soil themselves for!

Parsley watches his mother as she laughs. First time in a long time, the weight is off her leaves. Parsley smiles until his thumb brushes the Furrow Book Journal in his overalls.

The book pulses. Parsley's joy vanishes.

PARSLEY

Pyrus... wait.

He shoves the journal under Pyrus's nose. The pulsing ink now forms a warning symbol over Lami's glossy diagram.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

I thought we're in the green. But look at the ink.

The "Supernova" page is pulsing with an angry, red sap-ink. Fresh text bleeds through: "MOON POLLEN SIDE EFFECT INCLUDES: SOLAR GRAVITY."

PYRUS

Ope. We're still in the red.

PARSLEY

Solar gravity? Why not Lunar? It makes no sense. It's a Moon Fungus! Not Sun?!

The page takes its time to ink out: "^_(ツ)/^"

PYRUS

I also failed astronomy, bookworm! None of it makes sense!

CREEEAK. Lami's chair groans. Her chair is being pulled downward, sinking toward the floorboards as if the gravity beneath her has quadrupled.

Rau quickly grapples onto Lami's chair with a vine.

Parsley gets their camera.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

(Dread)

Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...

Photo!

Parsley snaps a photo of Lami as she sinks.

FLASH. The image captures Lami looking like a glowing star, while a crack in the floor opens directly beneath her.

Verbena rips away the photo and gets everyone back on track.

VERBENA

No photosynthesis allowed on set!

Verbena pushes a cameraperson closer. Her shades fly off.

VERBENA (CONT'D)

Get the wide shot! The way the ground is crumbling around her diamonds... it's a commentary on the fragility of fame! It's high-concept! It's G E T TV gold!

LAMI

I'm going to blow up!

PARSLEY

Actually, Madam Mentha, you aren't going to blow up.

RAU

Not helping, son.

PARSLEY

A common misconception! Blowing up is an outward release of energy like grapes in a microwave.

QUICK ANIMATION: GRAPES sit in a microwave. They glow, expand like balloons, then POP!

BACK TO SCENE:

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

What you're experiencing is *cytorrhysis*.

LAMI

Cyto-what? Is that a designer brand?

PARSLEY

The design is... rather than
exploding, you're going to collapse
inward until you're a tiny, dense
minty ball.

RAU

Are you dense?! Lami, he means
you'll be lean by the end of this!

The hip-hop track distorts. Lami is waist-deep in the floor,
her chair disappearing into a hole that oozes neon-green sap.

LAMI

(Voice vibrating)

The exfoliation is so... tectonic.
Rau, I can feel the very heartbeat
of the planet. Is this part of the
transplant experience?

RAU

(Losing her grip)

Exactly! It's... *Geo-Rejuvenation!*
Parsley! Whatever setting you put
that steamer on, turn it down
before we're looking for a new
salon at the bottom of a sinkhole!

PARSLEY

I can't turn it down! It wasn't the
steamer! Pyrus and I swapped the
mist for Moon Fungus pollen!

RAU

(Eyes wide)

Moon Fungus? That nature hike?!

PARSLEY

It's increasing her density by a
five-thousand percent! She's not a
superstar anymore... Lami's a black
hole!

VERBENA

Black hole?! This is G E T, not B E
T!

Pyrus slides across the slick and sappy floor.

PYRUS

Lil herb! The sap-line is gonna
blow! If she sinks another inch,
we'll be sent straight to Woody
Holly!

Parsley flips through the Furrow Bark Journal.

PARSLEY

I'm looking! I'm looking!
Wait—here! "In case of heavy-
heartedness or high-density
distress, apply high-frequency
vibrations to reset the cellular
pitch!"

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

Pyrus, the saxhorn! We need to
rattle her molecules back to a
lighter frequency!

PYRUS

I've been waiting my whole life for
someone to say those words.

Pyrus whips a battered saxhorn from their hoodie. They take a
deep breath, their cheeks puffing out like a ripe gourd.

PARSLEY

One, two, three... JAM!

Pyrus blasts a dissonant, ear-splitting JAZZ-FUSION CHORD.
It's messy, it's loud, and it's perfectly high-frequency.
Bombus dives into the center of the sound wave, his wings
vibrating so fast they become a transparent blur.

BOMBUS

BBBBBBBBUUUUUUZZZZZZZZZZZZZZZZZZZZ!

The air in the salon literally shakes. Dust falls from the
ceiling. The emerald glow on Lami flickers violently. It
turns from solid green to a translucent, airy teal.

LAMI

(Giggling)

Ooh! It tickles! I feel...
greenlight! I feel... effervescent!

With a sound like a giant suction cup being released: PLOP!

Lami begins to float. She rises out of the sap-filled hole,
her chair still attached to her roots, bobbing gently toward
the ceiling like a minty cork in a pond.

Rau anchors Lami.

RAU

Got her! She's light as a dandelion
seed!

Verbena checks her monitor.

VERBENA

The physics make zero sense, but
the visuals are breathtaking. Lami,
look into the lens and give me
"Ascended Goddess!"

PARSLEY

We saved Salontro! We saved the
salon from the superstar!

Parsley looks as the Journal sends one more footnote:
"Warning: Floating may cause temporary loss of common sense."

Lami floats upside down, in deep fascination at the abyss.
Her face is lit from below by the neon-green sap, giving her
a ghostly glow.

LAMI

It's giving "Deep-Rooted Despair."
I'd like to buy this hole. Rau, can
we incorporate the sinkhole into
the permanent aesthetic? It's so
underground.

Lami turns to the camera.

LAMI (CONT'D)

In the garden nation of Woodwork,
you have to dig deep to find your
shine. Stay soiled, my sprouts.

VERBENA

That is a wrap on location! Someone
get me a production photo for the G
E T social media!

PYRUS

Oh? I thought there were no
photosynthesis allowed on set?

Verbena snatches a pair of oversized shades from the crew.

VERBENA

Rules are weeds, kid. I pull them
when they get in my way. Everyone,
get in the hole. I mean, the shot!

FLASH. The image captures Lami pointing into the glowing
sinkhole, Rau and Parsley winking, Bombus dangling Pyrus over
the hole, Verbena tripping, and the production crew.

PRE-LAP: The sound of truck doors shutting.

EXT. SALONTRO - LATER

The last of the production trucks pack up.

The giant hole is under construction.

Verbena hands Rau a signed "Golden Leaf" contract.

VERBENA

This "Greenlight" segment is going to be the highest-rated episode in Mint Condition history. You're the highlight, Rau. Salontro is...

Rau seems dazed, clutching the contract. She forces a smile.

RAU

Green-la-la- We're in the green...

VERBENA

Red alert. Not quite. I can't believe we forgot the *afterparty*!

The GET production crew quickly returns and installs neon lights. Verbena snaps her fingers. RAU strikes a pose.

"GREENLIT" SONG

RAU

I'VE SPENT YEARS TRYING TO BLEND
PRUNING EVERY BRANCH SO I WOULDN'T
OFFEND
A GARNISH ON THE SIDE, A FLAVOR
THEY FORGET
BUT US INVASIVE SPECIES HAVEN'T
PEAKED JUST YET.

PARSLEY

I'VE BEEN SWEEPING UP THE DIRT,
TRYING TO STAY SMALL
BUILDING UP MY ROOTS BEHIND A
GARDEN WALL
THEY TOLD ME "STAY SAFE, BLEND INTO
THE MULCH"
BUT I CAN FEEL A RHYTHM IN THE
CELLULAR PULSE.

RAU & PARSLEY

NO MORE LIVING IN THE CRACKS OF THE
SIDEWALK STONE
NO MORE GROWING IN A SHADOW THAT
WE'VE OUTGROWN!

RAU, PARSLEY, PYRUS
WE ARE GREENLIT!
FINALLY STEPPING OUT OF THE GREY
WE ARE GREENLIT!
LET THE CHLOROPHYLL LEAD THE WAY!
WE'RE NOT JUST A GARNISH, WE'RE THE
WHOLE CANOPY TREE
FINALLY BLOOMING FOR THE WORLD TO
SEE!

CHORUS
PHOTOSYNTHESIS! PHOTO-PHOTO-PHOTO!

PYRUS
OPE! LOOK AT THE LENS, LOOK AT THE
GLOW
WE'RE THE MAIN EVENT, WE'RE THE
CENTER OF THE SHOW
THEY USED TO WALK PAST, THEY USED
TO LOOK DOWN
BUT NOW THIS DIRTY CITY WEARS A
NEON CROWN!

RAU
I WANT THEM TO KNOW MY NAME AND MY
FACE
I WANT TO BE MORE THAN A TRANSPLANT
IN THIS SPACE!
RESPECT IS THE WATER, FAME IS THE
SUN
THE SEASON OF HIDING IS FINALLY
DONE!

COMPANY
WE ARE GREENLIT! (PHOTOSYNTHESIS!)
WE'RE GREENLIT! (PHOTO-PHOTO-PHOTO)
THE CANOPY IS OPEN, OUR LEAVES
BELIEVE
THE WORLD FINALLY SEES...
THE COLOR OF OUR DREAM!
WE'RE GREEN!
LIT!

Underneath the strobe lights, Rau and Parsley stand triumphantly amongst the other plants.

END OF "GREENLIT" SONG

VERBENA
Pear. We got to get your saxhorn on
a future episode.

Rau crosses her arms in defiance.

RAU
Redlight that idea.

Verbena smiles and struts to her limo.

Lami pauses at the door, her skin faintly shimmering emerald,
and winks at Parsley.

LAMI
(With a knowing smirk)
Unbe-leaf-able work today, garnish.
But tell your mom if my leaves feel
this heavy tomorrow, I'm sending my
lawyers to prune this salon and
garnish your wages.

Lami heads off to her limo.

Pyrus nudges Parsley.

PYRUS
She just called you "unbe-leaf-
able." *But let's ignore the part
about the lawsuits.*

PARSLEY
That's our motto. You returned the
Journal?

PYRUS
Now Salontro's a library? I've
never returned a book to a library.

Parsley is about to spray Pyrus with the Moon Fungus juice.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
Okay okay! Supernova is super no
more.

The limos and trucks speed off, immediately lining up behind
the broken redlight.

Malus walks over from FigLeaf, leaning against the doorframe,
watching the line of vehicles.

MALUS
They really needa fix that light.

A loud CRUNCH. The floorboard underneath Rau caves in. Rau
yelps, vanishing up to her knees in the dark crawlspace.

RAU
...And my floorboard.

The tension also breaks. Malus, Parsley, and Pyrus burst into laughter.

Bombus lands on the edge of the hole. With lightning speed, they dip their stinger into the green sap and inks text across the floorboards: "WANNA GREENLIGHT A PHOTO?"

RAU (CONT'D)
Whatever, honey...

Bombus gets out the Salontro cam. They buzz to the "Photosynthesis" tune.

PARSLEY, PYRUS, RAU, MALUS
Photosynthesis... photosynthesis...
Photo!

FLASH. The final photo captures Rau dripping with gooey ointment and holding the contract, Malus being chill, Bombus soaring, Pyrus making a jazz-hand, and Parsley looking into the camera with a look that says: I'm just getting started.

On the bottom of the photo is a hand-written glowing green text: "Photosynthesis was GREENLIT"

END OF PILOT

VISUAL CUE: The end credits feature a montage of all photos taken throughout the episode, interspersed with behind-the-scenes production stills and concept art. The images are a scrapbook of the adventure and spirit of *Photosynthesis*.